

Dumbbell rotation in an electrostatic field

Y24 (2024) — English translation

This problem is devoted to the study of the dynamics of a system of conducting bodies placed in a uniform electrostatic field of intensity $\vec{E}_0$. The system under consideration is an electrically neutral dumbbell consisting of two metal balls of radius r with a distance $l \gg r$ between their centers. The balls are connected by a very thin cylindrical rod. The mass of each of the balls is m , and the mass of the rod can be neglected. Let us introduce the vector $\vec{l}$, denoting the radius vector of the second ball relative to the first (see figure).

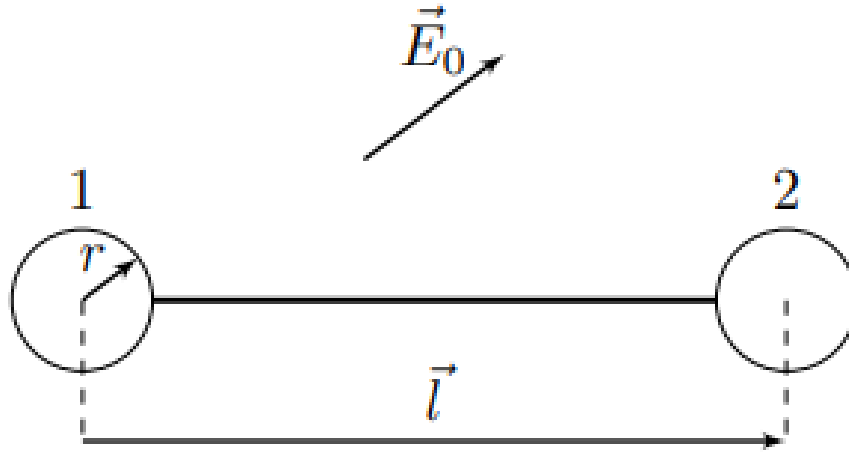


Figure 1: Figure 1.

Part A: Metal rod (2.0 points)

In this part of the problem, the balls are connected by a metal rod. We will call the induced dipole moments of the balls and rod the dipole moments of the electrically neutral ball and rod, respectively, acquired by them when placed in an electrostatic field far from other bodies. In all points of this problem, neglect the induced dipole moments of the balls and the rod, and also assume that the charge distributions over the surfaces of the balls are uniform.

A1	Determine the dipole moment of the dumbbell $\vec{p}$. Express your answer in terms of $\vec{E}_0$, r , ε_0 and $\vec{l}$.	0.50
A2	Determine the moment of force $\vec{M}$ acting on the dumbbell. Express your answer in terms of $\vec{E}_0$, r , ε_0 , $\vec{l}$.	0.20
A3	Find the equilibrium positions of the system. As an answer, indicate the values of the angles α_0 between the rod and the direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$.	0.20

A4 Which of the equilibrium positions you found in point A3 are stable and which are unstable? Justify your answer. Also find periods of small oscillations near stable equilibrium positions. Express your answers in terms of l , R , m , E_0 and ε_0 . **0.50**

A5 In a stable equilibrium position, the rod was instantly given an angular velocity $\vec{\omega}_0$ perpendicular to the electric field. At what minimum initial angular speed ω_{min} can the dumbbell make a full revolution? Express your answer in terms of l , r , m , E_0 and ε_0 . **0.60**

Part B. Rotation with constant angular velocity (2.6 points)

Let the system rotate around an axis perpendicular to the rod with a constant angular velocity $\vec{\omega}$. The direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$ forms an angle θ with the plane in which the rod moves (see figure). The figure shows the position of the dumbbell at the moment when the rod lies in the plane containing the axis of rotation and the direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$. Take the moment of time $t = 0$ to be the position corresponding to the figure. In this part of the problem, the rod is not metal, but has a resistance R between its ends.

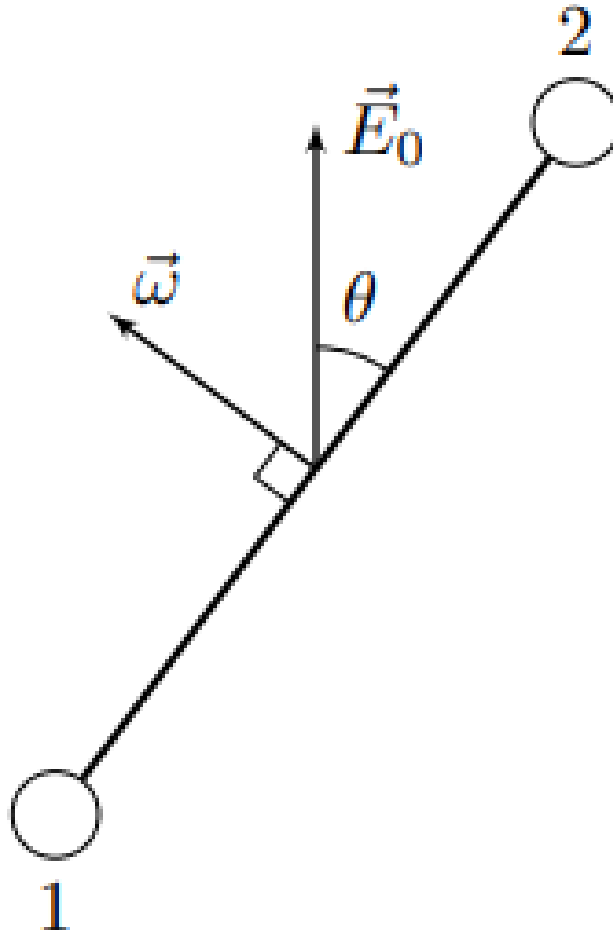


Figure 2: Figure 2.

- B1** Write down the equation that determines the current strength I in the rod. **0.90**
 Show that the current in our system is equal to the current in some RLC circuit connected to the alternating harmonic voltage generator $\mathcal{E}(t)$. Using the resulting equation, determine the parameters of the equivalent circuit: time dependence of the EMF of the equivalent generator $\mathcal{E}_{eff}(t)$, inductance L_{eff} , capacitance C_{eff} and resistance R_{eff} . Express your answers in terms of E_0 , l , r , R , ε_0 , ω , θ and t .

Further, in all points of the problem, consider that only forced oscillations occur in the system.

- B2** Obtain the time dependence t of the projection $p_l(t)$ of the dipole moment of the dumbbell onto the axis directed along the vector $\vec{l}$. Express your answer in terms of E_0 , l , r , R , ε_0 , ω , θ and t . **0.50**

In all subsequent points of the problem, if the rod has a resistance R , it is so small that the voltage across the resistor is much less than the effective amplitude $\mathcal{E}_0$ of the voltage from point B1.

- B3** Simplify your answer for $p_l(t)$, obtained in step B2, taking into account the smallness of the resistance R . The simplified answer should contain only quantities whose order of smallness in R does not exceed the first. Express your answer in terms of E_0 , l , r , R , ε_0 , ω , θ and t . **0.20**

Let us introduce a rectangular Cartesian coordinate system xyz as shown in the figure. Here, the z axis is directed along the direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$, and the x axis lies in the plane of the figure.

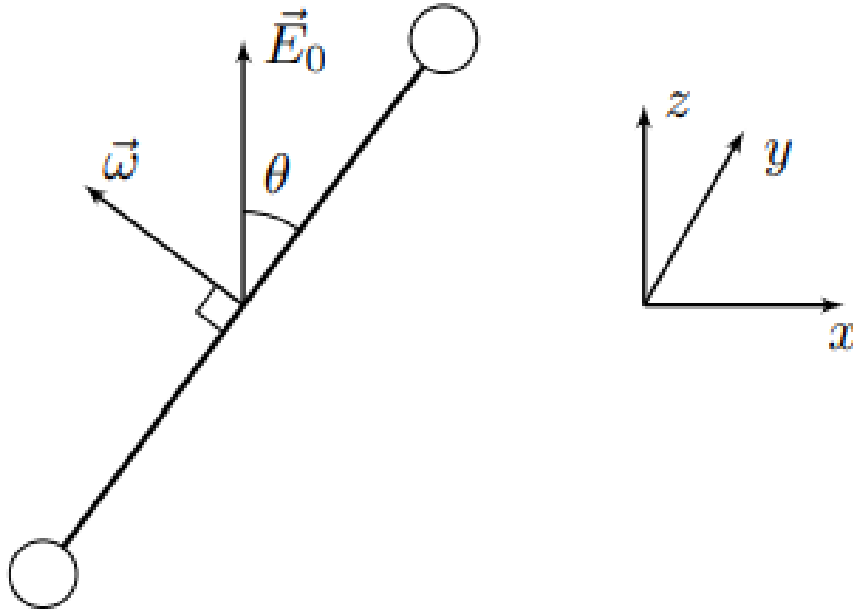


Figure 3: Figure 3.

- B4** Determine the long-time average dipole moment components $\langle p_x \rangle$, $\langle p_y \rangle$ and $\langle p_z \rangle$ of the dumbbell. Express your answers in terms of E_0 , l , r , R , ε_0 , ω and θ . **1.00**

Part C: Flat Dumbbell Movement (0.8 points)

In this part of the problem, the resistance of the rod is R . In a position of stable equilibrium, the rod is given a large angular velocity $\vec{\omega}_0$, perpendicular to the direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$. Consider $\omega_0 \gg \omega_{min}$, where ω_{min} was defined by you in step A5.

C1 Find the time dependence t of the angular velocity of the rod $\omega(t)$, assuming that $\omega(t) \gg \omega_{min}$ at any time and $t \gg 2\pi/\omega_0$. Express your answer in terms of ω_0 , E_0 , l , r , R , ε_0 and t . **0.50**

C2 Estimate the time τ after which the rod stops making full rotations. Express your answer in terms of ω_0 , E_0 , l , r , R and ε_0 . **0.30**

Part D. Precession of the rod (4.6 points)

This part of the problem is devoted to studying the dynamics of the spatial movement of a dumbbell in an electrostatic field. It turns out that for a very fast rotating dumbbell there is a regime of motion in which on average it experiences regular precession around the z axis. Regular precession means a mode of motion of the dumbbell in which the plane of rotation of the rod rotates around the axis z with a constant average angular velocity Ω_z , and the angle θ between the plane of motion of the rod and the direction of the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$ remains constant.

In the mode corresponding to regular precession, the angular velocity vector of the dumbbell $\vec{\omega}$ is represented in the following form:

$$\vec{\omega} = \vec{\omega}' + \vec{\Omega} \quad (1)$$

where $\vec{\Omega} = \Omega_z \vec{e}_z$ is the precession angular velocity, and $\vec{\omega}'$ is the angular velocity of the dumbbell in a reference system rotating with the average angular velocity of precession of the plane of motion of the rod.

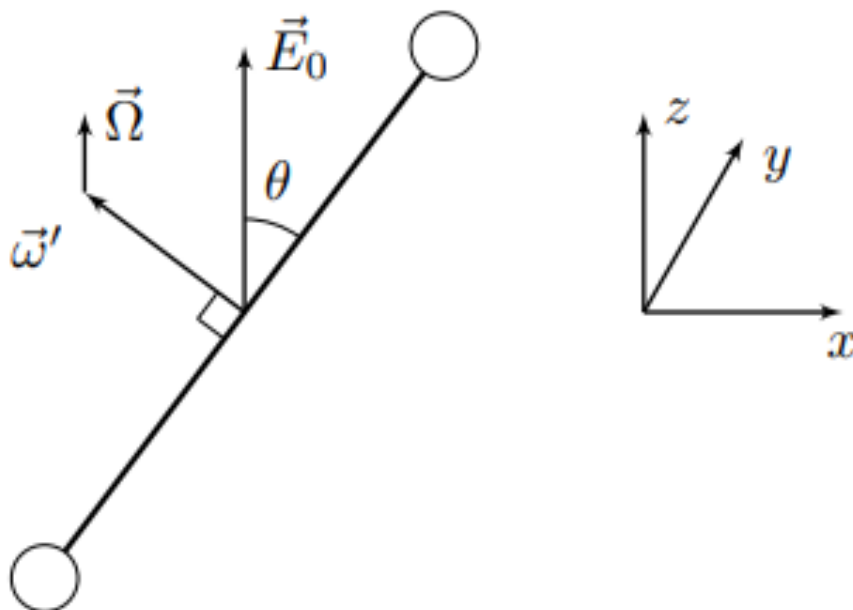


Figure 4: Figure 4.

Assumptions for this part of the problem:

- Consider that at any moment the dumbbell rotates with an angular velocity ω' many times greater than $\omega_{\min}$.
- Unless otherwise stated, assume that the angular velocity ω' is many times greater than the average angular velocity of precession Ω_z .
- All components of the angular velocity vector of the rod (including $d\theta/dt = \dot{\theta}$) can be considered constant during the time during which the rod makes one revolution in its plane of rotation.
- Write all equations of motion of the rod in the form of averages over the time of one revolution of the rod in its plane of rotation.

D1	Obtain an exact expression for the angular momentum $\vec{L}$ of a dumbbell in regular precession mode. Express your answer in terms of $m, l, \vec{\omega}'$ and $\vec{\Omega}$. Simplify your answer to include $\Omega_z \ll \omega'$.	0.50
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D2	Show that it is possible for a dumbbell to move in such a way that it experiences, on average, regular precession around the z axis. Give all the relevant equations of motion from which you base your proof. Determine for this mode of motion the average angular velocity of precession of the plane of motion of the rod Ω_z . Express your answer in terms of $E_0, \varepsilon_0, m, l, r, R, \omega'$ and θ . Also express the answer in terms of $\omega_{\min}, \omega'$ and θ and verify that $\Omega_z \ll \omega'$.	1.50
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Let at the initial moment of time the electrostatic field strength $\vec{E}_0$ make an angle θ_0 with the rod. The dumbbell is imparted an angular velocity $\vec{\omega}_0$, the modulus of which is much greater than $\omega_{\min}$, directed perpendicular to the rod as shown in the figure. Let us take into account the resistance of the rod R . Due to the smallness of R , we can still assume that the voltage across the resistor is much less than the effective amplitude $\mathcal{E}$ of the voltage from point B1.

Over a time of the order of $1/\omega_0$, the dumbbell goes into a mode of motion corresponding to slowly changing precession. During the transition, the loss of kinetic energy of the dumbbell can be neglected. With slowly changing precession, the values Ω_z and θ change very slowly with time due to the small resistance R . Since the angle θ begins to change, for a given mode of dumbbell movement, the angular velocity vector is written in the following form:

$$\vec{\omega} = \vec{\omega}' + \Omega_z \vec{e}_z + \dot{\theta} \vec{e}_y \quad (2)$$

where $\vec{\omega}'$ is the angular velocity in the rotating frame, with $\omega' \gg \dot{\theta}, \Omega_z$.

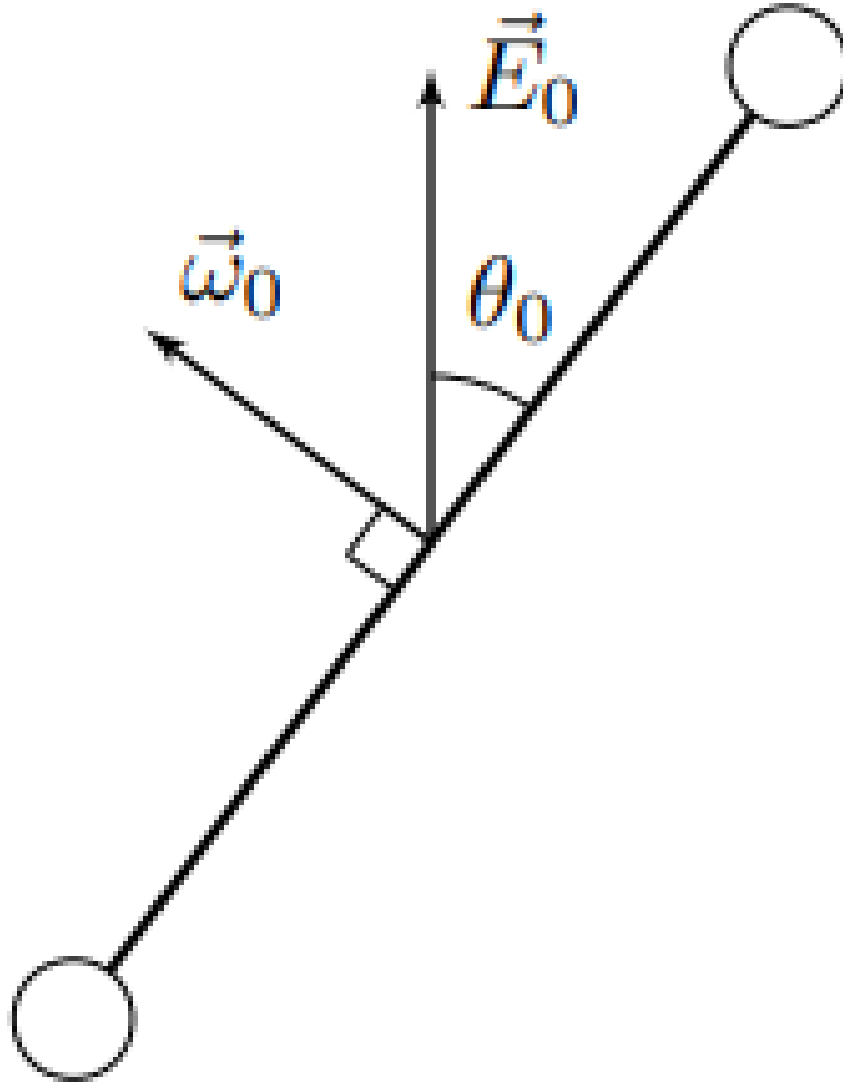


Figure 5: Figure 5.

D3	What is the steady-state angular velocity of rotation of the rod ω_∞ after a large period of time? Express your answer in terms of ω_0 and θ_0 .	0.50
D4	Obtain the dependence of the average angular precession Ω_z on the angle θ . Express your answer in terms of ω_{min} , ω_0 , θ_0 and θ .	0.50
D5	Obtain the time dependence t of the value θ at $t \gg 2\pi/\omega_0$. Express your answer in terms of θ_0 , E_0 , m , r , R , ε_0 and t .	1.00
D6	Determine the maximum value of $\dot{\theta}$. Express your answer in terms of θ_0 , E_0 , m , r , R and ε_0 . Make sure $\dot{\theta}_{max} \ll \omega_0$.	0.40
D7	Find the dependence of the precession rate on time $\Omega(t)$. Express your answer in terms of E_0 , ω_0 , m , r , R , ε_0 , θ_0 and t .	0.20

Source: <https://pho.rs/p/3817>